The Alchemy of Masks: Extension - The Reconstitution Method

Introduction to the Reconstitution Method

Why This Extension?

The alchemical method developed so far (Perturbation -> Metaphors -> Transmutation) makes it possible to dissolve masks and reach wounds in order to transform them. However, some wounds, especially those connected with deep trauma, require a more targeted approach: the benevolent reconstitution of the traumatic scene.

This extension explores a powerful technique inspired by exposure therapy, psychodrama, and EMDR, adapted to our alchemical framework. The central idea is simple:

> *"If a trauma was experienced once in a destructive way, it can be symbolically re-experienced in a reconstructive way."*

What Is the Reconstitution Method?

The Reconstitution Method is a four-step process that makes it possible to:

1. Recreate a traumatic scene in a subconscious state (where the ego is less active).
2. Replay the scene, but this time modify the outcome through the benevolent intervention of the alchemist.
3. Replace the traumatic memory with a reconstructive experience (memory superposition).
4. Reintegrate this new experience into the psyche in order to defuse the trauma's emotional charge.

> *Key metaphor: "A trauma is like a scratched film that keeps looping in our mind. Reconstitution is like rewriting the ending: we keep the same actors and the same setting, but change the script so that it carries meaning and healing."*

When Should This Method Be Used?

Reconstitution is presented as particularly useful for relational trauma (e.g., humiliation, betrayal, abandonment), irrational fears (e.g., phobias, social anxiety), limiting beliefs rooted in past events (e.g., "I do not deserve love"), and emotional blocks (e.g., inability to cry or express anger).

When to avoid it:

- Severe trauma (rape, physical/sexual abuse, complex PTSD): refer to a professional, ideally a therapist specialized in trauma.
- People in a psychotic or dissociative crisis: risk of retraumatization.
- Any situation without the person's clear consent.

Prerequisites for the Alchemist

5. Master the basics of mask alchemy (perturbation, metaphors, transmutation).
6. Have worked on your own traumas, to reduce projection or countertransference.
7. Create a safe setting: a calm environment without interruptions, where the person feels secure.
8. Obtain explicit consent: "Would you like us to explore this memory together, in a benevolent way?"

Part 1: Theoretical Foundations of Reconstitution

Chapter 1: Why Reconstitution Works

1. Traumatic Memory vs. Normal Memory

Traumatic memories are described as differing from ordinary memories:

Normal Memory	Traumatic Memory
Integrated in time (past -> present)	Frozen in the present (re-experienced as “here and now”)
Voluntarily accessible	Intrusive (flashbacks, nightmares)
Coherent narrative	Fragmented (sensations, images, emotions without context)
Low emotional charge	Intense emotional charge (fear, shame, helplessness)

Problem: the brain treats the trauma as a current threat, even years later.

Proposed solution: reconstitution allows the memory to be recategorized as belonging to the past and given a new meaning.

2. The Role of the Subconscious State

For reconstitution to work, the text proposes that the person enter a state of deep relaxation in which:

- The ego is less active (less resistance and denial).
- The subconscious is accessible (memories, emotions, symbolic images).
- The body is relaxed (the source text refers here to Bessel van der Kolk and the idea that trauma is stored in the body).

Suggested ways of reaching this state:

- Deep breathing (cardiac coherence, 4-7-8 breathing).
- Guided visualization (e.g., “Imagine you are in a safe place, such as a forest or a beach...”).
- Extended metaphors - the method’s key tool; see Chapter 2.

3. Memory Superposition

The source proposes that the brain does not always sharply distinguish reality from imagination, referring broadly to neuroscience research on brain plasticity. By replaying a traumatic scene in modified form, a new memory trace is said to be created that may:

- Reduce the emotional intensity of the original memory.
- Change the meaning associated with the event (e.g., “I was not weak; I survived”).
- Integrate resources missing from the original memory (e.g., support, protection).

Scientific example given in the source: therapies such as EMDR (Eye Movement Desensitization and Reprocessing) are said to use a related principle to help patients rework traumatic memories.

4. Benevolent Role-Play and Role Reversal

Replaying the role of the “aggressor” or trauma trigger may seem counterintuitive, but the text presents it as useful for:

- Giving the person a sense of control: they can “respond” differently this time.
- Correcting cognitive distortions (e.g., “I could do nothing” -> “Now I can see that I had options”).

- Restoring symbolic justice (e.g., “Now I can finally defend myself”).

Spontaneous role reversal - a key nuance:

In practice, roles may reverse spontaneously during reconstitution. The person who was originally the “victim” may begin playing the aggressor, and vice versa. The source interprets this as a sign that hidden dynamics are being explored.

- Why it may happen: the subconscious recognizes hidden dynamics. The “victim” may also contain parts that acted aggressively, such as repressed anger or guilt. Reversing roles can integrate these parts and reveal that situations are rarely entirely binary.
- Concrete example: someone reconstituting a conflict with an authoritarian parent may start playing the parent and shouting, then realize: “Wait... this is how I feel when I shout at my own children!” The text interprets this as revealing a transgenerational cycle to break.
- How to accompany the reversal: do not interrupt; encourage exploration (“Interesting... what is it like to play this role?”); validate insights (“So a part of you also understands what the other person may have felt.”).

Caution:

- Never reproduce the original physical or verbal violence.
- Always remain within a benevolent framework: “I am playing [X], but with respect and compassion.”
- Respect spontaneous role reversals and follow them without judgment.

Chapter 2: The Extended Metaphor - A Key to Accessing the Subconscious

What Is an Extended Metaphor?

An extended metaphor is developed over several stages and progressively guides the person toward a subconscious state. Unlike a one-off metaphor, it weaves a story that:

9. Captures attention (the brain follows the thread).
10. Activates imagination (the subconscious engages).
11. Creates a light trance state (the ego relaxes).

> *“Imagine that your memory is like a river. Normally it flows calmly, but sometimes rocks block the current. Today we are going to travel down this river together, and when we see a rock, we can choose to go around it... or blow it apart. And you will be the captain of the boat.”*

How to Build an Extended Metaphor

12. Ground it in reality: begin with a concrete image connected to the person’s experience. Example for betrayal: “Your friendship with [X] was like a garden you watered every day...”
13. Introduce the problem: describe the trauma metaphorically. “...until one day someone trampled your flowers without warning.”
14. Invite exploration: propose a symbolic journey to “revisit” the scene. “What if we went back into that garden, but this time you are not alone? What if we could plant new seeds where the flowers were crushed?”
15. Resolution: offer a reconstructive outcome. “Now imagine that every seed you plant becomes a tree stronger than ever.”

Examples of extended metaphors by type of trauma:

Trauma	Extended Metaphor	Goal

Public humiliation	“Your shame is like a play in which everyone saw you stumble. Today we will step onto the stage again, and this time the audience will applaud your resilience.”	Restore self-confidence.
Abandonment	“Your heart is like a house whose door was left wide open. Today we will close it... but with a new lock, and only you hold the key.”	Emotional security.
Professional failure	“Your project was like a sandcastle washed away by the tide. Today we will build a lighthouse in its place, one that guides others.”	Give meaning to failure.
Verbal aggression	“The words that hurt you are like arrows lodged in your back. Today we will remove them one by one, and each time you will feel lighter.”	Emotional release.

Techniques for Deepening the Subconscious State

16. Sensory anchoring: “What do you see/hear/feel in this metaphor?” The source says this activates sensory memories connected to the trauma.
17. Dialogue with symbols: “If that rock in the river could speak, what would it say?” This is presented as a way to access repressed emotions.
18. Change of perspective: “What if you watched this scene from the riverbank, like a benevolent observer?” The source calls this positive dissociation.

Part 2: The Reconstitution Method - Detailed Steps

Chapter 3: Preparation - Creating the Conditions for Reconstitution

Step 0: Preliminary Assessment

Before starting, ask the person - or yourself - these questions:

19. Are they emotionally ready? Signs of unreadiness: complete denial, anger at the idea of discussing the event again, frequent dissociation.
20. Do they have a support system? Reconstitution may bring up strong emotions, so the text says it is important to have someone to turn to afterward, such as a friend or therapist.
21. Is the trauma “treatable” alone? The source lists relational trauma, specific fears, and limiting beliefs as examples of “yes,” and complex trauma (prolonged abuse), dissociative disorders, and psychosis as “no.”

Step 1: Induction of the Subconscious State

Objective: bring the person into a state in which the ego is relaxed and the subconscious is accessible.

Methods:

22. Guided breathing (5-10 min): “Breathe in deeply through your nose to a count of 4... hold for 4 seconds... breathe out slowly through your mouth to a count of 6. Imagine each exhalation carrying away some tension.”

23. Progressive muscle relaxation: ask the person to tense and release each muscle group from feet to face, pairing each release with a metaphor, e.g., “Your shoulders are like mountains releasing their snow...”
24. Safety visualization: “Imagine a place where you feel completely safe. Describe it in detail: colors, sounds, smells. This place will be our anchor throughout the process.”
25. Extended induction metaphor: “Close your eyes and imagine walking down a spiral staircase. With every step you feel calmer and lighter. When you reach the bottom, you are in a sacred space where nothing can hurt you...”

Check:

- Ask: “On a scale of 1 to 10, how relaxed do you feel?” The source suggests 7/10 or higher as ideal.
- If the person is too anxious, return to relaxation techniques or stop the session.

Step 2: Activation of the Traumatic Memory

Objective: bring up the traumatic memory in a controlled way, without retraumatization.

26. Indirect approach through metaphor: “Return to the river we discussed earlier. Is there a place where the water is murky, or where you feel something blocking the current?”
27. Direct approach, if the person is ready: “Can you describe the scene where you first felt [emotion connected with the trauma]?” Tip: use neutral words such as “the situation” instead of “your trauma.”
28. Body anchoring: “Where do you feel this emotion in your body right now?” The source says this helps locate the memory in the body.

Signs of retraumatization:

- Dissociation (blank stare, disconnection).
- Hyperventilation or panic attack.
- Intense reliving, as if the trauma were happening now.

What to do:

- Stop the reconstitution immediately.
- Bring the person back to the here and now: “Open your eyes. You are safe here with me. Breathe deeply.”
- Use the safety anchor, such as the safe place imagined earlier.

Step 3: Benevolent Reconstitution and Role-Play

Objective: replay the traumatic scene with a modified outcome, using role-play to empower the person. Roles may reverse spontaneously during the process, which the source treats as a therapeutic opportunity.

29. Define the roles flexibly: the alchemist says, “I will play [name of aggressor/trigger], but in a respectful and benevolent way. You can be yourself, or a version of yourself with more resources. If at any point you want to change roles, that is completely normal.” The person may answer, “All right. But this time I will not stay silent.”
30. Begin the reconstitution: replay the scene from the beginning, slowing down near the key moment. Example: the alchemist as teacher says neutrally, “So, [Name], as usual you did not know the answer...” The adult responds, “This time I will say: I need help understanding.” The person may then spontaneously ask to switch roles, and the alchemist follows the reversal.
31. Intervene to change the outcome: introduce resources such as supportive friends, remind the person of the right to say no, or play a protective role. If roles reverse, explore the new perspective and facilitate an internal dialogue between parts of the self.

32. Bring the scene to a reconstructive ending: the ending should include resolution (the person defends themselves, is heard, or receives support), healing symbolism (a broken object is repaired, a wound is dressed), and, after role reversal, integration of both perspectives.

    Example ending: "Now you take the stone that symbolizes your shame and throw it into the river. Watch the water carry it away..." If roles reversed: "What happens now if you become yourself again, with this new understanding?"

Role-play rules:

- Never reproduce the original physical or verbal violence.
- Remain benevolent: even while playing the "aggressor," keep your tone neutral or compassionate.
- Let the person lead the evolution of the scene, including role changes.
- Welcome role reversals instead of forcing the person back to the original role.

Step 4: Reintegration and Safety

Objective: anchor the new experience and ensure the person is stable before ending.

33. Return to the present: "Take a deep breath... and open your eyes. You are back here with me, safe."
34. Body anchoring: "Feel your feet on the floor. Feel the air on your skin. You are here, now."
35. Validation and reinforcement: "What you just did was incredibly courageous. You changed the past in your mind, and that is a tremendous power."
36. Optional closing ritual: write a letter to your past self; burn a paper representing the trauma or plant a seed; shake the body to "release" remaining emotions.
37. Safety: do not leave the person alone immediately afterward; offer water, a hug if appropriate, or silence; check their emotional state on a 1-10 scale.
38. Follow-up plan: ask whether they want to talk again the next day and whether they have someone they can share the experience with.

Part 3: Practical Applications and Examples

Chapter 4: Concrete Examples of Reconstitution

Example 1: Humiliation Trauma (School)

Context: a person was humiliated in front of the class at age 12 by a teacher who laughed at their answer. Since then, they are afraid of public speaking.

39. Preparation: extended metaphor - "Your memory is like a cassette that always jams in the same place. Today we will play it again, but this time you have the remote control." Induction: breathing plus visualization of a safe place, such as a quiet library.
40. Activation: "Return to that classroom. What do you see? What do you feel in your body?" The person describes the teacher, the laughter, and their shame.
41. Reconstitution: the alchemist, as the teacher, says neutrally, "So, [Name], you still do not know?" The adult responds, "Actually, teacher, I need a little more time. And I would like you to stop putting pressure on me in front of everyone." The class is imagined as nodding or smiling. The reconstructed ending has the person leaving the classroom with their head held high and hearing: "This experience no longer defines who you are."
42. Reintegration: ritual - write "I deserve to be heard" on a piece of paper and keep it in a pocket. Safety - offer water and stay with the person for ten minutes.

Result given in the source: the person speaks in a meeting one week later without anxiety.

Example 2: Abandonment Trauma (Childhood)

Context: a man was abandoned by his father at age 7. Since then, he has difficulty trusting in relationships.

43. Preparation: “Your heart is like a house with a door wide open. One day someone left without closing it, and ever since you have been afraid of drafts. Today we will close that door... but with a new lock.”
44. Activation: return to the day the father left and describe what is seen - the suitcase, the mother in tears, and the feeling of helplessness.
45. Reconstitution: the alchemist, as the father, says gently, “I have to leave, but it is not your fault.” The adult asks, “Why did you not tell me you loved me?” The alchemist replies, “I loved you. Even if I did not show it as I should have, I am proud of you.” The reconstructed ending has the man symbolically embrace his father and close the door of the house.
46. Reintegration: draw the house with the door closed and a new lock; later tell this new version to his partner.

Result given in the source: he becomes able to express his needs in his current relationship.

Example 3: Fear of Dogs (Childhood Trauma)

Context: a woman was bitten by a dog at age 5 and has since avoided all dogs, including harmless ones.

47. Preparation: “Your fear is like a horror movie you keep replaying. Today we are going to change the ending: what if the dog became your ally?”
48. Activation: return to the park and describe the dog, its size, and its barking.
49. Reconstitution: the alchemist makes a friendly “Woof!” The adult says the dog looks sad and imagines holding out her hand. The alchemist says the dog wags its tail and only wants to play. In the reconstructed ending, the dog licks her hand and she realizes it is not dangerous.
50. Reintegration: stroke a stuffed dog while repeating “Dogs can be kind”; later watch videos of playful dogs for gradual desensitization.

Result given in the source: one month later she dares to approach a dog on a leash.

Chapter 5: Exercises for Practicing Reconstitution

Exercise 1: Solo Reconstitution (Self-Alchemy)

Objective: apply the method to yourself for a minor trauma.

51. Choose a memory: a painful event, but not an overwhelmingly intense one, such as an argument or failure.
52. Induce relaxation: use 4-7-8 breathing for 5 minutes.
53. Activate the memory: describe it aloud or in writing.
54. Reconstitute: imagine reliving the scene, but this time say what you did not dare to say, receive the support you should have had, and change the outcome.
55. Reintegrate: write the new version of the story. For anchoring, clap your hands and say, “It is over. I am safe now.”

Example: you were ignored by a group of friends; in the reconstitution you express your sadness and they listen with empathy.

Exercise 2: Role-Play in Pairs

Objective: practice reconstitution with a partner, friend, or loved one.

- Person A: the “patient,” choosing a mild trauma.
- Person B: the alchemist, guiding the reconstitution.

56. Preparation: Person B uses an extended metaphor to induce relaxation.
57. Activation: Person A describes the scene.
58. Reconstitution: Person B plays the “aggressor” benevolently, while Person A changes the outcome.
59. Reintegration: both discuss the experience.

Debriefing questions:

- “What was most powerful for you?”
- “Did you notice any resistance?”
- “How do you feel now about this memory?”

Exercise 3: The Trauma Box (Practical Extended Metaphor)

Objective: use a concrete metaphor to work on a trauma. Materials: a box, paper, and pencils.

60. Write the trauma: briefly describe the scene on a piece of paper.
61. Box metaphor: “This box is like your mind. The paper is the memory taking up too much space. Today we are going to rewrite this paper.”
62. Symbolic reconstitution: tear up the paper to symbolize destruction of the old memory; write a new version on a new sheet, with a reconstructive ending.
63. Reintegration: safely burn the old paper and keep the new one in a special place, such as under your pillow.

Part 4: Precautions, Limitations, and Ethics

Chapter 6: Risks of Reconstitution

The source emphasizes that the Reconstitution Method is powerful but carries risks if misused.

1. Retraumatization

Risk: the person relives the trauma with the same intensity and cannot exit the experience.

Signs:

- Panic attack.
- Dissociation - blank stare, disconnection from reality.
- Intense reliving, as if the trauma were happening now.

Prevention:

- Always begin with deep relaxation.
- Go slowly and do not force the person to relive the scene too quickly.
- Have an emergency plan for bringing the person back to the present through sensory grounding or a safe-place anchor.

If it happens:

64. Stop the reconstitution immediately.
65. Bring the person back to the here and now: “Open your eyes. You are safe here with me. Breathe deeply.”

66. Use the safety anchor.
67. Consult a professional if the person remains in distress.

2. Countertransference (for the Alchemist)

Risk: the alchemist projects personal emotions onto the person or identifies too strongly with the trauma.

Signs:

- Feeling overwhelmed by the person's emotions.
- Losing neutrality through excessive anger or sadness.
- Wanting to "save" the person at any cost.

Prevention:

- Work on your own traumas before helping others.
- Set boundaries: "I cannot carry your burden in your place."
- Supervision: discuss sessions with a mentor or peer.

3. False Memory

Risk: the person invents details that were not present in the original memory, especially if the alchemist makes too many suggestions.

Prevention:

- Do not direct the reconstitution; let the person guide the process.
- Avoid leading questions. Replace "Did your father shout at you?" with "What do you hear in this scene?"
- Stay faithful to facts. If improbable elements appear, ask: "Was that part of the original scene, or is it a new image?"

4. Dependency

Risk: the person becomes dependent on the alchemist in order to "heal."

Signs:

- Wanting sessions every day.
- Taking no initiative to apply changes in everyday life.
- Idealizing the alchemist: "Only you can help me."

Prevention:

- Encourage autonomy: "What can you do yourself to anchor this change?"
- Limit the number of sessions, e.g., "We can do another one in two weeks and see how you feel."
- Refer to other resources: books, support groups, professional therapy.

Chapter 7: When to Call a Professional

The source states that some cases require professional intervention:

Situation	Why?	Recommended Professional
Complex trauma (prolonged abuse, neglect)	Risk of retraumatization or severe dissociation.	Trauma specialist (EMDR, IFS, somatic approaches).
Dissociative disorders (DID, amnesia)	The person may lose contact with reality during reconstitution.	Psychiatrist or dissociation-focused therapist.
Suicidal thoughts	Life-threatening emergency.	Psychiatric emergency services or crisis line.

Psychosis (hallucinations, delusions)	The person may confuse reality and reconstruction.	Psychiatrist.
Severe depression	Reconstitution may bring up emotions that are too intense.	CBT therapist or psychoanalyst, as stated in the source.

Golden rule: "If in doubt, refer to a professional. Better safe than sorry."

Chapter 8: Ethics of Reconstitution

The source describes the method as giving great power to alter the way memories are experienced and to work with deep wounds, and therefore requiring great responsibility.

1. Informed Consent

Mandatory: the person must understand what the method involves and accept the risks.

- Explain the process clearly: "We are going to revisit a difficult scene, but benevolently, in order to change its impact on you."
- Mention risks: "Strong emotions may come back. Are you ready to face them?"
- Ask explicitly: "Would you like to try this method with me?"

Avoid:

- Forcing someone to relive a trauma.
- Minimizing risks, such as saying "It will not be that difficult."

2. Confidentiality

Rule: everything shared during a reconstitution session must remain confidential.

Exceptions listed in the source:

- If the person expresses danger to themselves or others, where reporting duties may apply depending on jurisdiction.
- If the person explicitly permits sharing, for example with another therapist.

3. Benevolent Neutrality

Your role:

- Be a guide, not a judge.
- Be a mirror, not a savior.
- Be an ally, not a parent or friend.

Pitfalls to avoid:

- Taking sides: even if the original aggressor was clearly in the wrong, remain neutral in tone.
- Giving unsolicited advice: the reconstruction should emerge from the person, not from you.
- Over-identifying with the person: remember, "This is not my trauma."

4. Integrity of the Method

Do not:

- Use reconstitution to manipulate someone.
- Mix it with other techniques without training, such as hypnosis or regression.
- Promise results, such as "You will be healed after one session."

Do:

- Stay humble: “I am here to accompany you, but you are doing the work.”
- Be transparent if you do not know how to handle a situation.
- Acknowledge your limits: “I am not a therapist. If this becomes too intense, I will refer you to a professional.”

Part 5: Integration with the Existing Alchemical Method

Chapter 9: Combining Reconstitution with the Three-Step Method

The Reconstitution Method does not replace the basic alchemical method (Perturbation -> Metaphors -> Transmutation). It enriches it for cases in which wounds are deeply anchored in traumatic memories.

1. Use the Basic Method to Prepare Reconstitution

- Perturb: make the person aware that they carry a mask linked to the trauma. Example: “You say you have moved past this breakup, but every time you speak about your ex, your voice trembles. It is as if part of you were still stuck there.”
- Reveal through metaphors: help name the wound without resistance. Example: “Your heart is like a house with a locked room. What if we opened that door together?”
- Partially transmute: offer a glimpse of possible healing to motivate the person. Example: “What if that locked room could become a sanctuary?”

Result proposed by the source: the person becomes more open to the idea of revisiting the scene.

2. Use Reconstitution to Deepen Transmutation

If the basic method is not enough - for example, the person understands intellectually that they have value but does not feel it - reconstitution is presented as a way to unblock the process by revisiting a scene of devaluation and experiencing a different outcome.

3. Use the Basic Method to Anchor Reconstitution

- Perturb if needed: “You changed the ending of this story. How do you feel now when you think back on it?”
- Reveal through metaphors: “Your memory was like a black cloud. Now it is gray, with flashes of sunlight.”
- Transmute: “What if you used this new strength for [concrete action]?”

Chapter 10: When to Choose Which Method

Situation	Recommended Method	Why?
Light mask (e.g., fear of public speaking)	Basic three-step method	Presented as sufficient to dissolve the mask.
Emotional wound (e.g., heartbreak)	Basic method + light reconstitution	Reconstitution may help release blocked emotions.
Relational trauma (e.g., humiliation, betrayal)	Reconstitution	The source says replaying the scene can change its impact.
Irrational fear (e.g., phobia)	Reconstitution	Presented as helping desensitize by changing perception.
Deep limiting belief (e.g., “I do not deserve love”)	Basic method + reconstitution	The source says reconstitution can challenge the belief.
Complex trauma (e.g., abuse)	Referral to a professional	Risk of retraumatization.

Conclusion: Becoming an Alchemist of Reconstitution

Summary of the Method

The Reconstitution Method is presented as a tool for working with wounds linked to traumatic memories. It is based on:

68. Inducing a subconscious state through extended metaphors and relaxation.
69. Benevolent reconstitution through role-play to change the outcome of the trauma.
70. Reintegration and safety in order to anchor the new experience.

> *Final metaphor: "A trauma is like a stone in your shoe. You can try to keep walking with a limp, but the stone will still be there. Reconstitution is like removing the stone and applying a bandage: you can finally walk freely, without pain."*

Keys to Success

- Practice on yourself first: use the method on your own wounds before applying it to others.
- Go slowly: do not force reconstitution; let the person guide the process.
- Remain benevolent: even while playing the "aggressor," the intention should always be healing.
- Always prioritize safety: make sure the person is stable before, during, and after the session.
- Know your limits: some wounds require a professional.

Your Mission

The source presents the Reconstitution Method as a gift for oneself and for people one may help, while emphasizing:

- You are not a therapist, unless you are actually one.
- You are not a savior: healing comes from within the person.
- You are a guide: your role is to light the path, not walk it in someone else's place.

By using the method with wisdom, compassion, and humility, the source says one may help others release traumas that hold them back, regain personal power, and create new stories for their lives.

Final Thought

> *"The past cannot be changed, but its hold on us can."*

As an alchemist of reconstitution, the source invites you to rewrite sad endings as stories of resilience, using this power with respect - one memory and one person at a time.

Appendix: Practical Sheets

Sheet 1: Quick Reconstitution Protocol

Step	Action	Example
Preparation	Induce relaxation + extended metaphor.	"Imagine that your memory is a river..."
Activation	Bring up the memory.	"What do you see on the banks of this river?"
Reconstitution	Replay the scene with a modified ending.	"This time, what happens if you say no?"
Reintegration	Anchor the new experience +	"Take a deep breath. You are

	ensure safety.	back here, safe.”

Sheet 2: Key Phrases for the Alchemist

Situation	Phrase
Induction	“Close your eyes and imagine walking down a staircase... With each step, you feel calmer.”
Activation	“Return to that scene. What do you see? What do you feel in your body?”
Reconstitution	“And this time, what do you do differently?”
Reintegration	“How do you feel now, in relation to this memory?”
Safety	“Open your eyes. You are safe here, with me.”

Sheet 3: Warning Signs - When to Stop

Sign	Action
Dissociation (blank stare, disconnection)	Stop immediately. Bring the person back to the here and now.
Panic attack (hyperventilation, uncontrollable crying)	Stop. Use the safety anchor.
Sudden anger (aggression, insults)	Stop. Give space.
Intense reliving (the person acts as if it were real)	Stop. Remind them: “That was in the past. You are safe now.”

Sheet 4: Emergency Resources

- France: Fil Santé Jeunes (0 800 235 236), SOS Amitié (09 72 39 40 50), national suicide prevention number (3114).
- Belgium: Télé-Accueil (107), Centre de Prévention du Suicide (0800 32 123).
- Switzerland: La Main Tendue (143), Tel 147 (for young people).
- Canada: suicide prevention line (1 833 456-4566), as listed in the source document.

Reminder: “Healing is not linear. Sometimes you have to go backward in order to move forward.”